Chapter 1

Build Your First Hotwire Native Apps

In this first chapter, we're going to dive right in and build a Hotwire Native app on iOS and Android from scratch.

The hiking journal apps you'll build in this book are powered by a small Rails server with some basic functionality built in. Hotwire Native, the framework we'll use to build the apps, renders HTML from your Rails server in an embedded web view, packaged inside a native app.

To run the Rails app, make sure you have Ruby 3.4.2 and SQLite[10] installed. And, if you haven't already, download and install Xcode[11] 16 and Android Studio[12] Meerkat or later, now. They're both pretty heavy IDEs and can take a while to download.

The reference code[13] that comes with this book has a bunch of subdirectories. Each corresponds to a different step when building the apps. Start with the code in `ch01_00`, meaning "chapter one checkpoint zero." Each time a code change is introduced in the book, it will increment the second number: `ch01_01`, `ch01_02`, `ch01_03`, and so on. Each chapter will increment the first number: `ch01_01`, `ch02_01`, `ch03_01`, and so on. Feel free to use these to double-check your work or as a checkpoint if you jump ahead to a later chapter.